

Practice Paper 50 — Answer Scheme

Paper 2 — Comprehension

Sections B & C

Note to teachers and students

- Marks are awarded for **meaning**, not for exact words. Where a quotation is required, it has been indicated in inverted commas.
- Where the question asks for **own words**, a candidate who lifts directly from the text receives **zero** for that mark unless the lifted phrase is unavoidable.
- For language and tone questions, accept any reasonable alternative that clearly fits the textual evidence.

Section B — Text 3 Answer Scheme [20 marks]

Q1. [2] — Careful, blocky letters

1 mark for identifying that she is **deliberately calm / methodical / disciplined**.

1 mark for explaining that **writing slowly is her way of stopping herself from panicking or making mistakes** under pressure; it reflects a **professional habit** developed over time.

Q2. [2] — Handler-dog relationship

1 mark — Bella reads the handler **intuitively**, even before the handler is consciously aware (she “lifted her head before I had even put the receiver down”).

1 mark — This suggests a relationship of **deep mutual trust and long familiarity**: they are **working partners**, not simply owner and pet.

Q3. [2] — Spare fleece “for the child rather than for me”

1 mark — It shows that the handler’s first thought is **the welfare of the person she is searching for**, not her own comfort.

1 mark — It suggests the work is **selfless / child-centred**, and that the handler has done this often enough to **anticipate the needs of a frightened, cold child**.

Q4. [2] — Parents “trying very hard not to cry”

1 mark — The **understatement / indirect phrasing** makes the parents’ distress feel more **real and dignified** than a direct description of weeping would.

1 mark — It also conveys the handler’s **calm professional restraint**: she notices and respects the parents’ attempt at composure rather than dramatising their pain.

Q5. [2] — “Steady, slightly impatient” look

(a) [1]: **Impatient** is surprising because we usually expect a working dog to be obedient and patient; it suggests that Bella **already knows what to do** and is **waiting for the handler to catch up**, almost as if she were the senior partner.

(b) [1]: It tells us the handler **trusts her dog's judgement more than human information** — Bella's instincts have proved more reliable, in the field, than any human report.

Q6. [2] — “Handlers who try to guide their dogs... find nothing”

1 mark — A **good handler must restrain herself**: she must resist the temptation to lead the dog towards where she thinks the child is.

1 mark — The **real skill** is in **reading** and **following** the dog's signals, because the dog's senses are far better than the handler's; over-controlling the dog **blocks its natural ability** to track scent.

Q7. [2] — Signs Bella has found something

1 mark each for any two of:

- Her **tail lifted** from “its working curve to a higher, quicker beat”.
- Her **ears pricked forward, then flattened, then pricked again**.
- She had “the air of a dog who was very certain about something”.
- She moved away at a **brisk, purposeful trot**.

Lifted quotations are acceptable here because the question asks for signs **from the paragraph**.

Q8. [2] — Trained dog does not run

1 mark — It shows the **thoughtful training** behind the dog's behaviour: every action has been considered in advance.

1 mark — It reveals an **awareness of the child's likely emotional state** — a frightened child seeing an animal running at them would panic; the dog must approach calmly to be helpful, not frightening.

Q9. [2] — Boy with the stick

1 mark — The stick “as though it were a sword” suggests the boy is **trying to be brave / defend himself / pretend he is in control**.

1 mark — His decision that “crying would not help” shows **unusual self-possession for a six-year-old**; together the two details suggest a child who is **frightened but determined to behave with courage**.

Q10. [2] — “Accepted, with great dignity”

1 mark — **Dignity** personifies the dog, giving her a **quietly noble, almost adult composure**.

1 mark — It captures the **gentleness of the moment** — Bella does not fuss or react excitedly; she allows the child to comfort himself by touching her, behaving with the **self-control of a true professional**.

Q11. [1] — Tone of the final sentence

1 mark — Any **one** of: **understated, quietly satisfied, calm, modest, reflective**. (Reject: **sad, triumphant** — both miss the quiet relief.)

Section C — Text 4 Answer Scheme [25 marks]

Q12. [2] — “Uncomfortably, urgently”

1 mark for **uncomfortably** — scientists are **uneasy** / **reluctant** / **troubled** by the idea of deliberately altering the climate.

1 mark for **urgently** — yet they feel a **pressing need** to discuss it now, because the climate situation has grown so serious that they can no longer afford to dismiss it.

Q13. [2] — Two families of geoengineering

1 mark — **Solar-radiation management** attempts to **cool the planet by reflecting sunlight away** (e.g. with aerosols or brightened clouds), addressing the symptom of warming.

1 mark — **Carbon-dioxide removal** attempts to **take the gas itself out of the atmosphere** (e.g. by planting forests or using direct-air-capture), addressing the underlying cause.

Reject answers that simply lift “solar-radiation management” without explanation.

Q14. [2] — Reasons to study geoengineering

1 mark each for any two of:

- The IPCC concludes that some **carbon-dioxide removal** is now **almost certainly necessary** to keep warming below 1.5°C.
- Solar-radiation management could **cool the planet within months**, not decades — a fast-acting emergency option.
- Refusing to study the options would itself be **irresponsible** — we cannot afford not to know what is possible.

Q15. [2] — “A kind of emergency brake”

1 mark — The metaphor compares geoengineering to a **brake on a vehicle**, something used **only in a sudden crisis** to prevent disaster.

1 mark — It captures the idea that solar-radiation management is **fast-acting** and **temporary** — meant to slow the climate down while slower, longer-term measures (cutting emissions) take effect.

Q16. [2] — Moral hazard (own words)

1 mark — **Moral hazard** refers to the risk that **the existence of a possible technological fix** makes people **less careful or less motivated** to solve the problem properly.

1 mark — In this case, if governments believe geoengineering will rescue them later, they will **delay or weaken the harder work** of cutting emissions now.

Reject lifted phrases such as “less urgency about the unglamorous, expensive work”.

Q17. [2] — Effect of the “single wealthy nation / individual” sentence

1 mark — It is **alarming** / **shocking**: the reader realises that climate-altering technology need not be controlled by a global agreement at all.

1 mark — It exposes the **governance gap** in dramatic terms — by reducing the threat to **one person**, the writer makes the danger feel immediate and personal, not abstract.

Q18. [2] — Harvard balloon and the public

1 mark — It shows that the public **no longer trusts scientists to act alone**, even on small, low-risk experiments.

1 mark — It suggests that **consultation and consent** are now expected before any climate experiment proceeds — the days of “scientists know best” are over, and **communities expect a voice**.

Q19. [2] — Substitute vs complement

1 mark — A **substitute** would mean **replacing emissions cuts with geoengineering**, which encourages governments to **abandon the difficult work** of reducing emissions.

1 mark — A **complement** would mean **adding geoengineering alongside emissions cuts**, which is the only responsible approach — the warning signals a **dangerous shift in political priorities**.

Q20. [2] — Field dominated by private donors

1 mark — Private donors fund research according to **their own interests and priorities**, not the interests of the public.

1 mark — Without **public oversight**, decisions about a technology that affects everyone could be made by **a small, unaccountable group** — which is **undemocratic and risky**.

Q21. [2] — Purpose of the closing line

1 mark — It **redirects the reader’s attention** from exotic technological fixes back to the **fundamental solution: cutting emissions**.

1 mark — It serves as a **quiet warning** — no amount of geoengineering can replace the simple, unglamorous discipline of **not emitting carbon in the first place**; the ending is **sobering and grounded**.

Q22. Summary [13 marks total: 6 content + 7 style]

Content points (½ mark each, max 6 marks). **Eight available content points; candidates should aim for all 8.**

Arguments in favour of taking geoengineering seriously (Paragraph 3):

1. The IPCC has judged **carbon-dioxide removal** to be **almost certainly necessary** to keep warming below 1.5°C.
2. **Solar-radiation management** could lower temperatures **within months rather than decades**, acting as a fast-acting emergency measure.
3. To **refuse to study** these options would itself be **irresponsible**, given the seriousness of the climate situation.

Concerns raised against it (Paragraphs 4–6):

4. **Unintended consequences:** the climate is unpredictable, and cooling one region may **disrupt the monsoons** and **food supplies** of another.
5. **Moral hazard:** belief in a future technological fix may make governments **delay the harder work** of cutting emissions.
6. **Governance gap:** there is **no international body** with authority to control deployment; a single wealthy nation or individual could act alone.
7. **Political language:** treating geoengineering as a **substitute** rather than a **complement** to emissions cuts is dangerous.
8. **Funding:** a field dominated by **private donors** without **public oversight** serves narrow rather than public interests.

Sample full-marks summary (78 words):

Supporters argue that geoengineering deserves serious study because removing carbon dioxide is now almost certainly needed to keep warming below 1.5°C, reflecting sunlight could cool the planet within months, and refusing to investigate would be irresponsible. However, critics warn that interventions may upset weather patterns and harm food supplies elsewhere, encourage governments to delay genuine emissions cuts, escape proper international control, mislead politicians into treating it as a replacement for action, and serve private donors rather than the public.

Length count: 78 words from “Supporters” onwards.

— END OF ANSWER SCHEME —